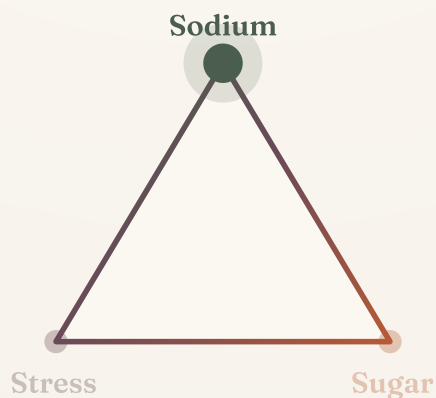


SODIUM CORNER . HERB FORMULARY



The Sodium Corner Herb Formulary

The herbs I trust for this corner, each with its dose, why it helps, and the cautions that matter.

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THE BP TRIANGLE . STRESS . SUGAR . SODIUM

The Sodium Corner Herb Formulary

These are the vascular herbs and the potassium seesaw for the sodium corner, the place where stress and sugar both empty out. They map onto the same pathways the prescription drugs target, used the way people have used them for generations. Talk to your doctor or pharmacist before combining any of these with prescription medication, especially blood-pressure, blood-thinning, or heart medication. We never stack a supplement on top of a medication blind. We loop in the professional.

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS EVERY HERB HERE

Add ONE at a time. Check your blood pressure daily. Tell your doctor everything you are taking. If you are on BP medication these can lower your pressure further, which is the goal under monitoring; if readings run consistently below about 110/70 or you feel dizzy, call your doctor about your medication dose. Never stop or change a prescription on your own.

The Formulary

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Hibiscus tea First pick for this corner	2 to 3 cups daily. Steep dried flower or a tea bag 5 to 10 minutes; drink warm or over ice.	The deep red anthocyanins act as a gentle natural ACE inhibitor (the same family of mechanism as a drug like lisinopril) plus a mild diuretic, and notably it does not flush potassium the way pharmaceutical water pills do.	Can lower blood pressure further, so use caution if already on BP medication. Talk to your doctor if pregnant or on any prescription.
Garlic (raw) Nitric-oxide support	2 cloves daily, crushed and rested 10 minutes before eating, taken with food. The rest activates the enzyme that forms the active compound.	Supports nitric oxide, the body's own vessel-relaxer, and circulation. One of the more strongly supported natural options for blood pressure.	Can increase the effect of blood thinners and may add to BP medication. Clear it with your doctor or pharmacist first if you take either.

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Cayenne pepper (capsaicin) Circulation warmer	About 1/4 teaspoon daily (start at 1/8 teaspoon), in warm water or on food, with food.	Capsaicin prompts nitric oxide release and supports vasodilation and circulation.	Take with food, not on an empty stomach. Go slow if you have reflux or a sensitive stomach.
Magnesium The throughline mineral, again	400 mg daily, glycinate or citrate (best absorbed), or an Epsom-salt bath (about 2 cups, soak 20 minutes).	Acts as a natural calcium-channel relaxant, easing the smooth muscle in vessel walls so the pipes open wider. You met it in the stress corner; here it does a different job. Most people are running low on it.	Avoid magnesium oxide (poorly absorbed). Reduce the dose if you get loose stools. If you have kidney disease, ask your doctor first, since the kidneys regulate magnesium.
Potassium (from whole food) The other half of the seesaw	Several servings of potassium-rich plants daily: leafy greens, sweet potato, beans, avocado, banana, tomato, coconut water. Food, not pills, unless your doctor directs otherwise.	Flips the sodium-potassium seesaw: signals the kidneys to excrete sodium and relaxes vessel walls directly. The natural counterweight a modern diet is missing.	If you have kidney disease or take a potassium-sparing or potassium-raising medication, do not load potassium without medical guidance.
Hawthorn berry Gentle cardiac support	Commonly used as a tea or a standardized supplement per product directions.	Traditionally used to support heart-rate regulation and cardiac function, in the spirit of a gentle beta-blocker-type support.	Can interact with heart and blood-pressure medications. Clear it with your doctor before use if you take any cardiac drug.
Celery seed (extract) Calcium-channel-style support	Per product directions.	Contains compounds that act as a natural calcium-channel relaxant plus a mild diuretic effect.	Can add to BP and diuretic medication; avoid concentrated extracts in pregnancy. Clear with your doctor if on prescriptions.
Cardamom Culinary vessel support	Used culinarily, or as a powder per traditional use.	Inhibits calcium movement in vessel walls (calcium-channel-blocker-type action) with a mild diuretic effect.	Generally well tolerated as a food. Discuss concentrated or supplemental use with your doctor if on BP medication.

Daily supports (free, and the backbone)

Hydration is the practice that makes the rest work: your body weight in pounds converted to ounces of water, water only, starting with about 16 ounces on waking and tapered before bed. It suppresses the vasopressin signal that constricts vessels and gives the kidneys the fluid to flush sodium. (If you have heart failure or kidney disease on a fluid restriction, follow your doctor's fluid target instead.)

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